

Incident handler's journal

Date: January 14, 2026	Entry: #1
Description	Cybersecurity Incident This incident occurred in the two phases: 1. Detection and Analysis: The scenario outlines how the organization first detected the ransomware incident. For the analysis step, the organization contacted several organizations for technical assistance. 2. Containment, Eradication, and Recovery: The scenario details some steps that the organization took to contain the incident. For example, the company shut down their computer systems. However, since they could not work to eradicate and recover from the incident alone, they contacted several other organizations for assistance.
Tool(s) used	None
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. • Who caused the incident? An organized group of unethical hackers. • What happened? Ransomware attack • When did the incident occur? Tuesday at 9:00 a.m • Where did the incident happen? At a small U.S. healthcare clinic. • Why did the incident happen? Phishing emails were sent containing a malicious attachment. When downloaded the attachment installed malware on the employees computers. When the attackers gained access they were able to deploy ransomware and encrypt key computer files needed for business operations.
Additional notes	

Date: January 20	Entry:#2
Description	Phishing Attack
Tool(s) used	VirusTotal.com which is an investigative tool that analyzes files and URLs for malicious content such as viruses, worms, trojans, and more. It's a very helpful tool to use if you want to quickly check if an indicator of compromise like a website or file has been reported as malicious by others in the cybersecurity community. For this activity, I used VirusTotal to analyze a file hash, which was reported as malicious. This incident occurred in the Detection and Analysis phase. The scenario put me in the place of a security analyst at a SOC investigating a suspicious file hash. After the suspicious file was detected by the security systems in place, I had to perform deeper analysis and investigation to determine if the alert signified a real threat.
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. • Who caused the incident? A malicious attacker • What happened? Phishing attack through email • When did the incident occur? January 20 2026 at 1:11pm • Where did the incident happen? Employee's computer at a financial services company. • Why did the incident happen? A phishing email was sent to an employee's email at the financial services company. The employee did not notice it was a phishing email and proceeded to download the email attachment and enter the password provided. After entering the password the file was opened and multiple unauthorized executables were created on the employees computer which alerted the SOC.
Additional notes	The file has a vendor's ratio of 51/71, malware detections, and a community score of -284 on virustotal.

Date: January 22, 2026	Entry:#3
Description	Ransomware Attack, Data Theft
Tool(s) used	
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. • Who caused the incident? A malicious attacker • What happened? Ransomware attack and data theft, employee contacted through email. • When did the incident occur? December 28, 2022, at 7:20 p.m • Where did the incident happen? Mid-sized retail company • Why did the incident happen? A malicious attacker exploited a vulnerability in the ecommerce web application to perform a forced browsing attack. This gave the attacker access to customer purchase confirmation pages that exposed customer data. The attacker collected and exfiltrated this data and used it as ransom by contacting an employee at the company and demanding payment. The employee assumed the initial email was spam and deleted it but was contacted a second time a week later with an email that contained real stolen customer data. The employee then notified the security team of the situation.
Additional notes	In the investigation it was discovered that the attacker was able to gain access by modifying the order number included in the URL string of a purchase confirmation page.

Date: January 15, 2026	Entry:#4
Description	Analyzing a packet capture file

Tool(s) used	For this activity, I used Wireshark to analyze a packet capture file. Wireshark is a network protocol analyzer that uses a graphical user interface. The value of Wireshark in cybersecurity is that it allows security analysts to capture and analyze network traffic. This can help in detecting and investigating malicious activity.
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. • Who caused the incident? • What happened? • When did the incident occur? • Where did the incident happen? • Why did the incident happen?
Additional notes	